warpath since his name was connected with Tony Rezko, the Illinois fundraiser currently on trial in America, who was one of Barack Obama's earliest backers. In the UK, the Times has been pursuing the story with impressive tenacity.' When Bright first posted these words, he was able to name the six articles censored by Auchi's legal efforts and removed from the online archive of the *Guardian/Observer*. Then, in a bizarre twist straight out of Kafka, Bright's *New Statesman* blog was itself subject to the interference of Auchi's long legal arm, and he was forced to remove the names of the censored articles and amend his own piece. The story is one of those that points up the baroque nature of journalistic fearfulness. When WikiLeaks reported the whole thing and the *New Statesman* tried to link to our coverage, they received a letter from legal firm Carter-Ruck.

By the end of 2008 we were drowning in leaked documents from all over the world. Every day brought new material, much of it requiring further research and commentary by us before publication. Had we been a single newspaper or a single broadcaster, we would've had the busiest investigations team in the world, turning out exclusive stories hand over fist. But WikiLeaks didn't see itself in the role of proprietor, or commercial engine, even though, I have to admit, commercial motives are often the only real metric with which to measure what a piece of information is worth. We didn't want to make money, but we wanted to deal with media organisations that could fasten our stories to a bank of journalists and a distribution network, and those organisations understood their work in commercial terms to do with tight deadlines and exclusivity. At this period, we were trying to learn to work with that while also keeping the website true to itself.

All sorts of stories were bursting over the dam: late in 2008 we released the membership list of the British National Party. This is a neo-fascist organisation that believes in a white-only Britain; yet their members included police officers, serving soldiers and government employees; people who have a moral and professional obligation to serve all British people equally, regardless of race. Then, in December, we put out a private report authored by the South African Competition Commission, which told of cartel behaviour in the big South African banks. The most important sections had been redacted, supposedly to protect commercially sensitive data, but we published the report in full. Here's an example of a 'commercially sensitive' sentence: 'It is evident that Absa failed to pass on